

Arrival choices

Previous lesson reminder:



A · A star above a stable



B · A party balloon

Start with 1 and 2. Try 3 and 4 when ready. Reading and exact scribing are available.

1 Give one meaning of light at Hanukkah.

Support: Use the reminder strip or talk it through with an adult.

My response

2 Which meaning fits incarnation?

Support: Choose: The Christian belief that God became human in Jesus OR The story of the birth of Jesus.

My response

3 Name one belief connected to Christmas.

Support: Use the model evidence anchor A or read one relevant card together.

My response

4 Is every Christmas tradition a Christian belief?

Support: Give a reason when ready.

My response

Stretch: use a precise example or explain which detail supports your answer.

Evidence cards

Read, point or listen. Keep the source label with any detail you use.

A The belief

Christians believe Jesus is the Son of God. The incarnation means God became human in Jesus. Christmas celebrates his birth.

Source: Authored RE summary

Limit: Christians explain the incarnation in different ways.

B The Nativity

Matthew and Luke tell different parts of the Christian Nativity accounts. Luke describes a manger and shepherds. Matthew describes wise men visiting Jesus. Many Christmas retellings combine these accounts.

Source: Authored summary of the Gospel accounts

Limit: The two Gospels include different details.

C Religious traditions

Nativity plays, carol services, Advent candles and Midnight Mass all point to the birth of Jesus. Many Christians call Jesus the light of the world.

Source: Authored RE summary

Limit: Belief and practice vary between individuals and communities.

D Cultural traditions

Trees, crackers, Father Christmas and turkey are enjoyed by many people of all worldviews. They are part of Christmas culture, not Christian belief.

Source: Authored classroom resource

Limit: Some traditions have both religious and cultural meanings for different people.

Shared investigation

1. Match each tradition to the belief or meaning it links to.
2. Decide which traditions are cultural.

Work with a partner or adult, or use your own table. One person suggests; the other checks the evidence. Swap after one turn. Passing is allowed.

Move or match the cards

Cards to use
Pulling crackers
Advent candles
A Nativity play

Possible labels: Cultural, not a belief / Jesus as the light of the world / The birth of Jesus

Our explanation

Support: Read one evidence card together. Highlight a useful detail. Rehearse with: This links to ____ because ____.

Further challenge: Explain why someone who is not a Christian might still celebrate Christmas.

Supported independent task

Complete this route only. Explain how one Christmas tradition links to a Christian belief.

1. Choose one tradition card with a picture.
2. Match it to a belief card.
3. Say or finish: This links to ____.

Support: Read one evidence card together. Highlight a useful detail. Rehearse with: This links to ____ because _____. Complete the organiser one space at a time. This links to ____ because _____.

My choice or example

A detail from the card story or object

My reason

My check or next step

An adult may read or scribe your exact response. They should not choose the answer.

Standard independent task

Complete this route only. Explain how one Christmas tradition links to a Christian belief.

1. Choose one Christmas tradition.
2. Match it to a Christian belief.
3. Explain: This links to ____ because ____.

Support: This links to ____ because ____.

My choice or example

A detail from the card story or object

My reason

My check or next step

Check the required evidence and revise one detail.

Stretch independent task

Complete this route only. Explain how one Christmas tradition links to a Christian belief.

1. Explain one religious tradition and the belief behind it.
2. Explain one cultural tradition and why it is not a belief.
3. Use the word incarnation accurately.

Support: Choose the evidence independently. Use the frame only if it helps.

My choice or example

A detail from the card story or object

My reason

My check or next step

Explain why someone who is not a Christian might still celebrate Christmas.

Exit ticket

Choose a response mode. You may give your answers privately to an adult.

Name one belief connected to Christmas.

My response

Is every Christmas tradition a Christian belief?

My response

Support: This links to ____ because ____.

Further challenge: Explain why someone who is not a Christian might still celebrate Christmas.

One thing I changed or want to check
